

NDFEX Trading Competition

Rules, Penalties & Scoreboard Guide

This document describes the server-enforced rules of the NDFEX trading competition, the consequences of breaching them, and how breaches are displayed on the live scoreboard.

1. Overview

Teams connect to the NDFEX matching engine and trade 13 symbols over a multi-day competition. A live scoreboard tracks each team's aggregate PnL, per-symbol positions, and rule violations in real time.

Two rules are enforced server-side. Breaching either rule triggers an automatic, permanent penalty applied to your score. The exchange does **not** reject orders that would cause a breach — it is each team's responsibility to manage risk.

2. Scoring

The competition runs over **two trading days**. Each day's PnL is calculated independently and combined into a final score using a weighted formula:

$$\text{Final Score} = 0.25 \times \max(0, \text{Day 1 PnL}) + 1.00 \times \text{Day 2 PnL}$$

Day 1 PnL counts at **25%** of its value, but is **clamped to a minimum of 0** — a negative Day 1 cannot hurt your final score. Day 2 PnL counts at **full value** with no floor. This means Day 1 is effectively a risk-free practice round: you can only benefit from it, while Day 2 performance dominates the final ranking.

Penalties from rule breaches (described below) are applied to each day's PnL **before** the weighting is applied.

Minimum Volume Requirement

To be eligible for the prize, a team must trade a minimum of **2,000 lots** (total volume across all symbols). Teams that do not reach this threshold are excluded from the final ranking, regardless of PnL.

The scoreboard displays a **VOL** tag next to each team name. The tag appears gray until the team reaches 2,000 lots, at which point it turns green.

3. Rule 1 — Position Limit

Limit

The absolute position in any single symbol must not exceed **10**. That is, for each symbol:

$$|\text{position}| \leq 10$$

Positions are tracked per-symbol. Long and short positions are both subject to this limit.

Penalty

When a team's absolute position in a symbol exceeds 10, that symbol's PnL contribution is **clamped so you keep losses but cannot profit**:

$$\text{penalized_pnl} = \min(0, \text{symbol_pnl})$$

If the symbol PnL is positive, it becomes 0. If it is negative, the loss is kept as-is.

Key details:

- The penalty applies **per-symbol** — breaching in GOLD does not affect your BLUE PnL.
 - The penalty is **permanent** once triggered. Even if you reduce your position back below 10, the clamp remains for the rest of the session.
 - If the symbol PnL is negative, you still keep the loss. The clamp only prevents you from profiting.
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4. Rule 2 — Minimum PnL

Limit

A team's aggregate PnL must not drop below **-5,000**:

$$\text{aggregate_pnl} \geq -5,000$$

Penalty

When a team's aggregate PnL drops below -5,000:

- PnL is **frozen** at the breach value (the exact PnL at the moment of breach).
 - The team's session is **effectively over** — further trading will not improve or worsen the score.
 - The penalty is **permanent** for the remainder of the trading session.
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5. Scoreboard Indicators

The live scoreboard uses visual indicators to flag rule breaches and volume eligibility:

Indicator	Location	Meaning
POS (orange tag)	Leaderboard, next to team name	Team has breached the position limit in at least one symbol

PNL (red tag)	Leaderboard, next to team name	Team has breached the minimum PnL rule
VOL (gray tag)	Leaderboard, next to team name	Team has not yet reached the 2,000-lot minimum volume
VOL (green tag)	Leaderboard, next to team name	Team has met the minimum volume requirement and is prize-eligible
Orange cell	Position matrix	The specific symbol where the position limit was breached

Indicators appear in real time as the scoreboard refreshes. All teams can see which teams have been penalized and which have met the volume requirement.

6. Exchange Restarts

If the exchange crashes or needs to be restarted during a trading session:

- Your current **PnL is saved** at the time of the crash.
- All open positions are **marked to the last traded price** for each symbol (i.e., the PnL impact of those positions is crystallized).
- All positions are **reset to 0**.
- The exchange restarts with a **fresh order book**.
- Teams keep their **accumulated PnL** from before the restart and continue trading from a flat position.

In short: a restart is like a forced liquidation at last price. You keep everything you earned (or lost), but start trading again from zero positions.

Rule breach flags (POS, PNL) persist across restarts. If you breached a rule before the restart, the penalty still applies.

7. Disputes

The exchange log file is the **final source of truth** for all disputes, including disagreements over positions, PnL, fill prices, or rule breaches. Every order, fill, and cancel is recorded in the log with timestamps.

If a team believes the scoreboard is showing incorrect data, they may raise a dispute with the instructors. The exchange log will be consulted to resolve the issue, and its record is authoritative and final.

8. Symbol Reference

The following 13 symbols are available for trading:

ID	Ticker	Name	Tick Size	Category
1	GOLD	Gold	10	Commodity
2	BLUE	Blue	5	Commodity
3	KNAN	Keenan Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)

4	STED	St. Edward's Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
5	FISH	Fisher Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
6	DILN	Dillon Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
7	SORN	Sorin Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
8	RYAN	Ryan Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
9	LYON	Lyons Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
10	WLSH	Walsh Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
11	LEWI	Lewis Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
12	BDIN	Badin Hall	5	Dorm (ETF underlying)
13	UNDY	Notre Dame Dorm ETF	10	ETF

GOLD and BLUE are standalone symbols not included in the UNDY ETF basket. The position limit of 10 applies to all 13 symbols equally.

9. Tips & Best Practices

- **Monitor your positions constantly.** The position limit of 10 is small — a few rapid fills can push you over.
- **Stay well within limits.** Aim to keep positions at 8 or below to give yourself a buffer against unexpected fills.
- **Use the scoreboard.** Check the position matrix to see your live positions across all symbols at a glance.
- **Watch your PnL.** If you're approaching -5,000, reduce risk immediately. Once breached, your session is over.
- **Day 2 matters most.** With Day 1 weighted at only 25%, use it to learn the market and test strategies. Save aggressive plays for Day 2.
- **Plan for restarts.** The exchange may restart during trading. Your bot should handle disconnections gracefully and be ready to reconnect and resume.